

SHIWEI LIAO

Doctoral Applicant | Media & Communication | AI & Institutional Authority | Platform-Mediated Health
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RESEARCH PROFILE

University of Melbourne Master of Global Media Communication graduate (WAM 80.38) studying how AI enables institutions to extend what they are authorised to say and do. My current doctoral direction compares AI health applications across Baidu, Tencent and ByteDance, examining how major Chinese digital platforms translate established roles in search and information, social communication and services, and content recommendation into new capacities for health interpretation, recommendation and service routing.

EDUCATION

Master of Global Media Communication 2023 - 2025
The University of Melbourne, Faculty of Arts - Melbourne, Australia

- WAM 80.38 (H1); completed July 2025. Minor Thesis: *Governing via AI Broadcasting in the Digital Era* - 87/100 (H1), approximately 12,750 words; supervised by Dr Wilfred Wang.
- Used Fairclough's critical discourse analysis and NVivo-assisted coding to examine how Chinese AI policy and CCTV's 2024 AI Gala construct technological legitimacy and state-media authority, establishing my broader interest in how institutions use AI to extend what they are authorised to say and do.
- Selected H1 results: Global Communication: Theory & Research (88); Media and Communications Thesis (87); Media Convergence and Digital Culture (86); Digital Politics (85); Researching Audiences and Reception (85).

Bachelor of Broadcast Announcing and Anchoring Art 2017 - 2022
Communication University of Zhejiang - Hangzhou, China

- Cumulative average 87.42/100. Training combined broadcast presentation, interviewing, media production and communication practice, providing an early foundation in institutional voice and mediated public communication.

SELECTED AWARDS

- Zhejiang Provincial Government Scholarship.
- First-class Scholarship, Communication University of Zhejiang.
- Outstanding Award, National Innovation and Entrepreneurship Programme for College Students (Yi Shu Yi Ying project).

PROPOSED DOCTORAL RESEARCH DIRECTION

AI, Institutional Authority and Platform-Mediated Health

- **Core question:** How does AI enable institutions to extend what they are authorised to say and do?
- **Current comparative focus:** Baidu, Tencent and ByteDance as major Chinese digital platforms whose AI health applications extend established roles in search and information, social communication and services, and content recommendation into health interpretation, recommendation and service routing.
- **Media and communication contribution:** examines how platform infrastructures, interface practices and service ecosystems reconfigure institutional roles, legitimacy, responsibility and authority as digital media companies enter health-related domains.

METHODS & RESEARCH SKILLS

- **Established:** critical discourse analysis; qualitative content analysis; semi-structured interviewing; NVivo-assisted coding; keyword-frequency/co-occurrence analysis; corpus organisation.
- **Developing:** comparative walkthrough; qualitative interface analysis; platform ecosystem analysis; comparative case-study design.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Seeing the City Through AI Glasses

Media Convergence and Digital Culture - 86/100, H1

Analysed AI smart glasses as wearable urban media infrastructure, extending my research from institutional AI discourse toward interfaces, media infrastructures and body-space-data relations.

Navigating the Privacy Paradox: TikTok's Role in the Digital Public Sphere

Researching Audiences and Reception - 85/100, H1

Used semi-structured interviewing and framing theory to examine how algorithmic curation shapes privacy perception, providing direct qualitative interviewing experience relevant to platform governance research.

Digital Silk Road in the Context of China's Digital Economy Work Points 2024

Global Data Policy & Governance - 80/100, H1

Analysed China's digital economy policy, data governance and cross-border infrastructure cooperation, supporting my interest in how institutional authority is organised across platforms and governance systems.

Media Marketing and Crisis Discourse on TikTok

Researching Media & Communications - 80/100, H1

Compared BBC and Guardian coverage of TikTok's data-privacy crisis through qualitative content analysis and NVivo-assisted coding, demonstrating training in platform crisis discourse, media framing and qualitative coding.

MANUSCRIPT IN DEVELOPMENT

From AI Gala to Spring Festival Gala: The Infrastructuralisation of AI Discourse in Chinese State Media

In preparation

Article manuscript extending the minor thesis by examining how AI shifts from a visible object of technological legitimisation to an embedded production condition in Chinese state-media ritual.

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Online Test Preparation Instructor (IELTS and PTE)

2023 - present

Freelance / Online

- Deliver one-to-one and small-group online instruction, including lesson planning, formative feedback, speaking and writing support, and individual learning guidance.
- Provides sustained teaching and student-support experience relevant to future university tutoring and sessional teaching.

Freelance Short-form Video Producer

2021 - 2023

Independent client work - China

- Sourced small-business clients independently and produced promotional short-form video content for Douyin, from concept development and client communication to on-location shooting and post-production editing.
- Applied end-to-end multimedia skills developed through broadcast training, including field interviewing, copy/script preparation, visual storytelling, shooting, presenting/voice work where required, and editing.

Media and Communications Intern

2018 - 2019

Hangzhou TV Group / Anji News Group - Hangzhou and Anji, China

- Conducted on-location public interviews and supported live-broadcast, short-video and media-production workflows in state-affiliated news organisations.
- Newsroom experience informs later research on institutional voice, state-media authority and mediated public communication.

RESEARCH INTERESTS & COLLABORATION

AI and institutional authority; platform governance; platform-mediated health; Chinese digital platforms; interface and service-pathway analysis; Chinese digital media and state media; qualitative and critical methods. Interested in contributing to media-and-communication, AI-and-society, platform-governance and digital-health research projects alongside doctoral study.